

TempusFugit

Tempus Fugit (Time Flies)

Configuration & Setup Guide

1. Pack Overview

TempusFugit is a carefully curated solo survival modpack built on NeoForge 1.21.1, with Sinytra Connector providing support for select Fabric mods. Designed around a philosophy where the world tells a story through geography rather than quest text. The surface is beautiful but dangerous, caves escalate in dread the deeper you venture, and structures are rare enough that finding one feels like a genuine discovery.

Core Design Pillars

- The Living World: terrain, creatures, structures, seasons
- Resources & Economy: ores, materials, villager trading, farming
- Survival & Progression: tools, weapons, armor, enchanting, food
- Danger & Combat: mob spawning, difficulty, boss encounters, death consequences
- Experience & Immersion: visuals, audio, UI, performance

The Danger Ladder

The world escalates in danger from surface to deep underground; each zone distinct, each with its own threats:

- Surface: Animal predators, mythological creatures and tribal civilizations inhabit the world day and night
- Dark Forests: Dense canopy blocks sunlight even at midday, allowing monsters to spawn freely within. These ancient woods are beautiful but genuinely dangerous.
- Cave Entrance: Vanilla monsters emerging from below mark the threshold between relative safety and active danger
- Mid Cave: Vanilla monsters and cave systems require preparation and caution
- Deep Cave: Tier 4-5 Ice & Fire Dragons
- Nether: A hostile amplified underworld
- End: Nullscape's vast alien desolation

2. Technical Specifications

Setting	Value
Java Version	Java 21 required
Mod Loader	NeoForge 1.21.1 + Sinytra Connector
Primary Launcher	CurseForge
World Seed	TempusFugit (recommended only)
Play Style	Solo Survival or small LAN server (recommended only)
Shaders	Complementary Unbound r5.8.1 or Photon 1.3b (recommended and optional)
Memory Allocation	4–8 GB (8 GB recommended)

3. World Generation Stack

Terrain & Biomes

- Tectonic: primary terrain shaper, dramatic mountain ranges and underground rivers
- William Wythers Overhauled Overworld (WOO): biome enrichment using only vanilla biome IDs, no new biomes added
- Lithostitched: world generation compatibility layer
- Amplified Nether: enhanced Nether generation
- Nullscape: End dimension overhaul, desolate and vast
- Serene Seasons + Serene Seasons Plus: seasonal changes throughout the year

Datapack Load Order

Maintained automatically via Paxi's datapack_load_order.json (no need to edit in game). WOO must remain highest priority to ensure correct biome generation over Tectonic.

Listed from lowest to highest priority:

- iaf_copper_pick_stone_tier_datapack.zip
- potion_ring_recipe.zip
- easymagic_reroll_catalyst.zip
- William Wythers' Overhauled Overworld v2.6.0.zip
- wwo_worldgen_overrides.zip
- tempusfugit_animalgarden_balance.zip (highest priority)

Structure Philosophy

Global structure spacing is set to 2.3x vanilla through Structurify, making structures rare and meaningful. Key individual overrides:

- Dragon Roosts: Fire Dragons are restricted to Desert, Ice Dragons to Snowy Plains, and Lightning Dragons to Swamp. Surface dragon encounters are intentionally rare, making each discovery a memorable event. Elder dragons seek solitude deep beneath the earth, where their vast cave systems and hidden treasure hoards await those brave enough to challenge them.
- Ocean Villages (Tidal Towns): 6x spacing, very rare ocean discoveries
- Galleons (Supplementaries): 6x spacing, extremely rare ocean encounters
- Ocean Monuments: halved frequency via individual override

4. Progression Systems

Tool & Weapon Progression

TempusFugit uses a natural survival progression path centered on exploration and creature encounters. The ultimate goal is defeating Ice & Fire's most powerful dragons to forge Dragonsteel, the pinnacle of weapons & armor.

Tier	Path	Gate
Flint Tools	Entry level crafting, some wooden tools disabled or weak	Starting point
Stone	Vanilla stone tools, require stone instead of cobblestone; reduced durability	Mine stone with flint tools
Copper	Ice & Fire copper tools and armor, smelted in vanilla furnace	Mine copper ore with stone tools
Iron	Hephaestus Smeltery, requires copper components and lava	Find iron ingots via loot or trade to build the smeltery controller
Diamond	Vanilla crafting + loot / trade	Exploration and trade
Netherite	Vanilla upgrade path	Nether survival
Dragonsteel	Ice & Fire crafting	Defeat tier 4-5 dragon

Key Progression Notes

- Punch a tree? What is this Minecraft?
- Some wooden tools are disabled; flint tools serve as an entry point for crafting.
- Ore reduction: all ores spawn at 50% vanilla rates, making resources feel meaningful and earned
- Only Hammers and Excavators: adds 3x1 area mining tools for stone and dirt type blocks. Wooden and stone variants are disabled; higher-tier versions become available starting in the Iron Age.
- Hephaestus Smeltery: build to produce iron ingots. Iron ore, deepslate iron ore and raw iron will only smelt to a single nugget in a furnace or blast furnace.
- Tool Belt: provides a dedicated belt slot via the Curios system for quick tool access
- Amethyst Shards: serve as the enchanting reroll catalyst for Easy Magic
- Sleeping: Better Days accelerates the passage of time rather than simply skipping the night

Enchanting & Anvil

- Easy Magic: items stay in the enchanting table, full enchantment preview, reroll enchantments using Amethyst Shards as catalyst at a small XP cost
- Easy Anvils: no “too-expensive” limit, halved book enchantment costs, name tags craftable, prior work penalty limited and manageable
- Fixed Villager Trades: prevents librarian farming exploits, keeping enchanted books as genuine discoveries

Flight Progression

- Mid game: Hippogryph (tameable via Ice & Fire), earned through world interaction
- Late game: Elytra, gated behind End survival and Nullscape's dramatic terrain

Magical Artifacts

- Just Potion Rings: found in End City, Desert Pyramid and Woodland Mansion loot, or crafted via anvil + potion effect book
- Base ring recipe: Elder Guardian Eye + 4 Gold Ingots (via datapack override)

5. Surface Danger Ecosystem

The surface threat has not been removed, it has been redesigned. Vanilla monster hordes have been replaced with a curated ecology of natural predators and mythological creatures that inhabit the world day and night. The surface feels alive rather than artificially dangerous.

Dark forests deserve special mention. Their dense canopy blocks sunlight even at midday, allowing monsters to spawn freely within. These ancient woods are beautiful but genuinely dangerous.

Vanilla Surface Exemptions

- Slimes: swamps and underground, moon cycle dependent
- Witches: wander at night across all biomes, solitary and dangerous but rare
- Husks: desert nights

Ice & Fire Surface Creatures

- Cyclops, Gorgon, Siren, Sea Serpent, Hippocampus
- Hippogryph, Stympalian Bird (an aerial threat)
- Death Worm: desert only
- Hydra, Pixie, Troll
- All Dread creatures
- Fire, Ice, and Lightning Dragon roosts

Animal Garden Predators

- Savanna / Desert / Jungle: Lion, White Rhino, Western Gorilla, Spotted Hyena
- Ocean / River / Swamp: Bull Shark, Alligator Gar, Crocodile, Hippo, Narwhal
- Frozen: Snow Leopard

Mowzie's Mobs

- Frostmaw: frozen biome apex predator
- Umvuthana + Umvuthi: tribal savanna civilization with their own society and territory
- Ferrous Wroughtnaut: underground chamber guardian

6. Configuration Changes

The following configurations have been intentionally modified from their defaults. Changes can be made via config file or in-game via the mod menu where available. All other configs remain at default.

Non-Folder Configs

Config File	Changes Made
animalgarden_bullsharkconfig.properties	Bull Sharks restricted to warm and lukewarm oceans; river spawning removed
betterdays-common.toml	clearWeatherOnWake = false, sleepSpeedMax = 50
Butchery.toml	Farmers Delight = true
easyanvils-common.toml	name_tag_crafting_recipe = true
easymagic-server.toml	dedicated_reroll_catalyst = true, enchantment_hint = ALL
fowlplay.json5	penguinSpawnWeight = 0 (Waddles used instead due to mod spawn error)
gravestone-server.toml	friendlyGhost = false
hiddenrecipebook-client.toml	shouldHideRecipeBook = true (vanilla recipe book hidden; JEI serves as primary recipe reference)
mowziesmobs-client.toml	play_boss_music = false, hide_player_anims_in_first_person = true
mowziesmobs-common.toml	Sculptor generation_distance = -1, Grottol / Lantern / Naga / Foliaath / Bluff / Elokosa spawn disabled
onlyhammersandexcavators-common.toml	DurabilityWoodenHammer = 1, aligns with Wooden Tools Are Dumb mod (flint is the intended entry point)
soundcontroller.json	Animal Garden and Fowl Play sounds reduced to 25% individually per animal
structurify.json	Global spacing 2.3x, multiple structures configured, see Section 3
treeharvester.json5	mustHoldAxeForTreeHarvest = true, "treeHarvestWithoutSneak": true
waystones-common.toml	chunksBetweenWildWaystones = 76, spawnInVillages = FREQUENT, XP costs off, cooldowns on, no inventory button, pets don't teleport, JourneyMap integration on
wooden_tools_are_dumb config	Difficulty set to Easy, removes wooden tool crafting, flint tools required as entry point
workshop_for_handsome_adventurer-common.toml	Chests are renamed for free = true

Folder Configs

Config Folder	Changes Made
incontrol	Amphithere and Cockatrice surface spawning disabled
ore_generation_configuration	global.json: default_keep_chance = 0.5 means 50% ore reduction globally. ores.json: all frontier rules neutralized to keep_chance = 1.0
paxi/datapacks	• potion_ring_recipe.zip: Elder Guardian Eye replaces the Lapis Block in the base Potion Ring recipe • easymagic_reroll_catalyst.zip: Amethyst Shard replaces the default Easy Magic reroll catalyst • William Wythers' Overhauled Overworld: Primary WWOO datapack used for world generation • datapack_load_order.json: Maintains automatic datapack load order via Paxi • iaf_copper_pick_stone_tier_datapack.zip: Overrides the Ice & Fire copper pickaxe to use stone-tier mining. Newly crafted copper pickaxes cannot harvest diamond-tier blocks • wwoo_worldgen_overrides.zip: Reduces hay and pumpkin field generation, removes scarecrows, and removes lanterns from Cherry grove Biome • tempusfugit_animalgarden_balance.zip: Balances Animal Garden spawn weights and group sizes
PeacefulSurface_Rules	DefaultRule.json: vanilla monster surface spawning suppressed with curated exemptions: slime, witch, husk and Ice & Fire surface creatures
stormiespiders	can_crawl_on_ceiling = true
iceandfire	iaf-common.json: generate.skeletons = false
structurify	Global spacing 2.3x: dragon roosts restricted to desert / snowy plains / swamp at 4x individual spacing. Monastery disabled. Galleons 6x. Ocean villages 6x. Ocean monuments halved Explorify structures curated
scripts (CraftTweaker)	• copper_durability.zs: Balances Ice & Fire copper tool durability • iron_nugget_smelting.zs: Iron ores smelt to nuggets, essentially gating iron ingot production behind the Hephaestus Smeltery • stone_tool_recipes.zs: Vanilla stone tool recipes require stone instead of cobblestone. • early_hammers_excavators.zs: Removes wooden and stone hammer/excavator recipes from Only Hammers and Excavators • farmers_delight_baking_rework.zs: Make Wheat Dough required for baked goods Pumpkin Pie output change to one per required for selected cooking recipes • supplementaries_pancake_rework.zs: Requires Milk Bottle only for recipe • Milk bottles only for baking recipes • vanilla_armor_rework.zs: Requires leather armor piece as the crafting foundation for all crafting table armor recipes • iceandfire_armor_rework.zs: Requires leather armor piece as the crafting foundation for all craftable Ice & Fire armor recipes • godly_dragon_seeker.zs: smithing table recipe added

7. In-Game Configuration Changes

The following changes were made via in-game configuration menus. All settings can be adjusted via config file or in-game via the mod menu where available.

Structurify

- Global spacing modifier: 2.3x
- Fire, Ice & Lightning Dragon Roosts: spacing 88 / separation 36, restricted to Desert / Snowy Plains / Swamp biomes
- Fire, Ice & Lightning Dragon Caves: spacing 18 / separation 12
- Mowzie's Monastery: disabled
- Nullscape Dragon Skeleton: atmospheric landmark, left enabled
- Butchery Vindicator Butcher's House: disabled
- Supplementaries Galleons: spacing 276 / separation 168 (6x vanilla)
- Tidal Towns ocean villages: spacing 306 / separation 72 (6x vanilla)
- Ocean Monuments: spacing doubled for both vanilla and YUNG's Better variants
- Explorify: Supply Cache, Mausoleum and Plains Watchtower disabled. Tavern restricted to open biomes

Shader Support (Optional but Recommended)

Pre-configured shader settings are included with the modpack and will be applied automatically when the selected shader is enabled in-game.

Complementary Unbound r5.8.1

- Custom pre-configured settings are included
- Euphoria Patches (included with the modpack as an optional enhanced shader option)

Photon 1.3b

- Custom pre-configured settings are included

The shader options presented are fully compatible with Distant Horizons.

8. Pack Distribution

TempusFugit is distributed via CurseForge:

<https://www.curseforge.com/minecraft/modpacks/tempusfugit>

Install directly through the CurseForge App. All required mods, configuration files, scripts, datapacks, resource packs, shader packs, and recommended settings are applied automatically. Refer to the project README for installation and first-time world setup instructions.

9. Compatibility Notes

Incompatibility	Details
Chisels & Bits	Incompatible with this modpack, the game will not load with Chisels & Bits installed. Do not add it.
Ice & Fire config	Ice & Fire's own config file is unreliable for spawn and structure changes. Use InControl and Structurify for all Ice & Fire spawn and structure control.
Sodium 0.6.13 (do not update)	Sodium is pinned to a specific version for stability. Updating Sodium to alpha or newer versions will break Iris and Reese's Sodium Options. Do not update.
Supplementaries 3.6.7	Supplementaries is pinned at 3.6.7 due to Sodium 0.6.13 fluid renderer compatibility issues in newer Supplementaries versions. Do not update.

TempusFugit is designed primarily for solo survival, but should also play well on a small LAN server with a few friends. Larger multiplayer servers have not been tested or officially supported.

The seed TempusFugit is only recommended and not required; it produces the spectacular views seen in the GitHub banner pic, and is a great starting point.

For questions or issues regarding the modpack, leave a comment in the Issues or Discussions sections here on GitHub; only refer to the individual mod pages for information and instructions specific to that mod.